Stay Safe Online: Essential Checklist

Protect your digital life with these 8 actionable steps. Whether you are browsing, shopping, or managing finances, these habits are your first line of defense.

Digital Hygiene & Privacy

- Turn on Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for email, social media, and banking. A password alone is no longer enough.
- Avoid conducting financial transactions or logging into sensitive accounts on public or open Wi-Fi networks.
- Keep your OS and apps updated to the latest versions to patch security vulnerabilities hackers exploit.
- Never click on suspicious links in SMS, WhatsApp, or emails—especially those offering "instant prizes" or "urgent account verification."
- Review app permissions regularly. Disable location sharing and microphone access for apps that don't strictly need them.
- Treat any job or investment offer requiring an "upfront registration fee" or "security deposit" as a scam.

Financial & UPI Safety

- PIN for Sending Only: Remember, you never need to enter your UPI PIN or scan a QR code to receive money.
- Transaction Limits: Set a daily UPI transaction limit within your payment app to minimize potential losses in case of unauthorized access.

How to Report Cybercrime

If you experience fraud or online harassment, act immediately:

1. Portal: Report details at cybercrime.gov.in
2. Helpline: Call 1930 instantly to report financial fraud and freeze stolen funds